

Unit Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- Identify few characteristics unique to one's self and other characteristics the all humans share in the selected countries of South Asia.
- Describe the influences that shape personal identity.
- Explore the factors that influence one's perception, attitudes, values and beliefs.
- Identify the communities he/she belongs to (for example, draw and describe pictures of the various groups they form a part of).
- Discuss about the rules of the various communities to which he or she belongs to.
- Explain what is a group?
- Describe a number of groups that people belong to.
- Describe the functions of the groups.
- Explain ways in which people are part of various communities.
- List benefits of belonging to groups.
- Describe roles that an individual can have within a group and across a range of groups.
- Give examples of how people may acquire roles.
- Explain what people do when they fulfill particular roles.
- Identify the rights and responsibilities individuals have within a group.
- Explain how rights and responsibilities might vary in different groups.

Introduction to the Unit

Have you ever wondered why individuals and societies are so varied? Do you ask what social forces have shaped different existences? The quest to understand society is urgent and important, for if we cannot understand the social world, we are more likely to be overwhelmed by it. We also need to understand social processes if we want to influence them. Sociology can help us to understand ourselves better, since it examines how the social world influences the way we think, feel and act. It can also help with decision-making, both our own and that of larger organizations. Sociologists can gather systematic information from which to make a decision, provide insights into what is going on in a situation, and present alternatives. In this unit, you will study about the role of individual, communities and groups in South Asia.

CHAPTER 1: INDIVIDUALS IN SOUTH ASIAN SOCIETIES

SLOs

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- Describe the influences that shape personal identity.
- Explore the factors that influence one's perception, attitudes, values and beliefs.
- Identify the communities he/she belongs to (for example, draw and describe pictures of the various groups they form a part of).
- Discuss the rules of various communities to which he or she belongs to.

Introduction

This chapter is about the people of South Asia. It describes the unique characteristics of the people of South Asia and the factors that influence individual personal identities. The South Asian countries have some of the world's oldest civilizations that are thousands of years old. Until the 1500s, Asia was known for its progress in culture and technology. South Asians founded cities, set up states and carved out trade routes.

In the previous chapters, you have learned that South Asia is made up of eight nations: Afghanistan, India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, and Maldives. However, these nations do not share a common culture. There have different languages and religions and social systems.

Characteristics of the Individual in South Asia

The people of South Asia possess several unique characteristics. They have different languages, religion, customs, tradition and ethnic characteristics that separates them from the rest of the world.

South Asian Countries	Languages	Religions	Festivals	Customs and Traditions	Ethnic Characteristics
Afghanistan	Pashto and Dari	Islam, Sikhism, Hinduism and Judaism	Eid-ul-Fitr, Eid-ul-Adha, Nauroz, Jashan-e-Afghan	Most of the South Asian countries practice common customs. Respecting elders is a must. People prefer living in joint family systems. Respecting guests is must. People love spicy food. Sports is the best recreational activity. Covering whole body and decent clothing are preferred. Visiting religious places are given due importance. It is disrespectful to use the left hands to give and take.	South Asia has a variety of different ethnic characteristics. There are the Dravidian people, who are found mostly in India, Sri Lanka, Pakistan, and Afghanistan. These people are categorized together because they are the descendants of the people who spoke the Dravidian languages. Another group is the Bengali people. These people are from the Bengali heritage, which is a group of the region, Bengal that is politically divided between Bangladesh and India.
India	Hindi, English, Regional Languages	Hinduism, Islam, Christianity, and Sikhism.	Holi, Diwali, Dashehra, Eid, Christmas		
Pakistan	Urdu, Punjabi, Sindhi, Balochi, Pashtoon	Islam, but has a small group practicing Christianity and Hinduism	Eid-ul Adha, Eid-ul-Fitr, Christmas, Easter, Diwali		
Bangladesh	Bangla	Islam, Hinduism	Eid-ul Adha, Eid-ul-Fitr		
Nepal	Nepalese	Hinduism, Buddhism, Islam, Kirantism, and Christianity.	Dashain		
Bhutan	Sharchhopka, Dzongkha, and Lhotshamkha	Buddhism and Hinduism	Tshechu	Shoes are to be removed before entering a worship place. Heads of women are to be covered. Men like to shake hands with other men. Women do not shake hands. They are permitted to nod. Eating food is done only by right hand.	
Sri Lanka	Sinhalese, Tamil and English	Buddhism, Islam, Hinduism, and Christianity	Diwali, Eid, Christmas		
Maldives	Dhivehi and English	Islam	Eid-ul Adha, Eid-ul-Fitr		A different group in South Asia are the Bhutanese who follow Tibetan Buddhism.

Activity:

- Imagine you are attending a young leaders' conference in South Asia. There are representatives from all the South Asian countries. Discuss and share the distinctive characteristics of the people of South Asia with each other.

Name of the South Asian Country	Sports	Dresses	Music	Dances	Languages	Custom and Traditions	Ethnic Characteristics
Afghanistan							
India							
Pakistan							
Bangladesh							
Sri Lanka							
Nepal							
Bhutan							
Maldives							

Personal Identity of People in South Asia

South Asian people's individual identities are influenced by many different aspects such as family, culture, friends, personal interests and surrounding environments. Some factors may have more of an influence than others and some may not have any influence at all. As a person grows up in a family, they are influenced by many aspects of their life. Family and culture influence a person's sense of responsibilities, ethics and morals, sports, and many other aspects of life. Some of the examples are speaking softly is a norm taught by the family. Loving cricket and getting excited for the matches is something that the traditions in South Asia have given to its people, enjoying TV and cinema is liked by most of the people, non-following of the traffic rules is another example of how people take advantage and disrespect the laws.

Activity:

- Study the diagram below. The left column contains the aspects that influence peoples' identities in South Asia. Discuss with your friends and write how these aspects have influenced the identities of the people of South Asia. Also write how it connects the individuals of one country to the other.

Aspects that Shape Identities	South Asian Context
 Family	
 Culture	
 Food	
 Festivals	

 Lifestyle	
 Sports	
 Media	

Factors that Influence Attitudes and Values of the People of South Asia

The factors that have influenced South Asian people are their belief systems, values, norms of their societies, social roles. For example, it is people's belief that all wishes are fulfilled by God and visiting worship places are mandatory.

Values: Respecting the elders, being polite to them and taking care of them is one of the values of South Asian societies.

Norms: Girls are not encouraged to move freely at night, whereas boys can go freely everywhere.

Societal Roles: Grandparents are the heads of the family who takes the major decisions for the children and grandchildren.

Activity:

- Work in groups of four to six students and select one South Asian country of your choice. Find information about each factor given below for the country you have chosen, discuss the information and fill the given column.

Factors	Description with Examples
Beliefs	
Values	
Norms	
Societal Roles	

Activity:**Communities within South Asia**

A **community** is a social unit of any size that shares common values, or that is situated in a given geographical area (e.g. a village or town). Every member of the society is a part of the community. There are many communities where children are active members such as health awareness, cleaning campaigns, writing communities and others. South Asia is rich in cultural diversity. The diverse groups of communities have defined rules, regulations, positions, values, traditions and customs.

- Search the internet/library and collect information on the different communities present within South Asia. Fill the graphic organiser with the name and characteristics of the communities you found.



It can be concluded that the South Asian countries comprise many communities that have particular features, norms and attitudes. The roles, responsibilities and status are defined by the society in the South Asian countries. The South Asian countries are rich in languages, customs, traditions, values and belief systems. Although there is a difference in how the people of the South Asian countries understand and practice different values and beliefs, they are still connected to each other because of the land they share.

SUMMARY

The unique characteristics of the people of South Asia are based on their language, religion, customs, traditions, festivals and ethnic diversity. The factors that influence individuals' identities in South Asia are family, culture, lifestyle, food, media, technology and festivals. The South Asian countries have many diverse communities living together. A community is a set of people with common values, norms and beliefs.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The language spoken in Bhutan is _____.
- ii. The main festival of Nepal is _____.
- iii. The most practiced religions of South Asia are _____, _____ and _____.
- iv. Define the following terms:
 - Community
 - Identity
 - Culture

2. Make a Poster and write how the South Asian countries are different from each other.

3. Prepare a Collage of the famous festivals of South Asia and display them in the class.

B. Use Your Inquiry/ Investigation Skills

1. In groups, think about and discuss the common values and beliefs of the South Asian countries and share with your class.
2. Draw and describe the communities you belong to.
3. Highlight the role and positions of your family in the community you belong.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Create a travel brochure about a trip to all the South Asian countries, featuring information on the culture and festivals of the countries.
2. Read a travel guide and highlight the major cultures and traditions of communities living within South Asia.
3. South Asia is becoming a modern region, but still has many traditional ways of how people live. Create a chart and list both modern and traditional aspects of the lifestyles of the people of South Asia.

CHAPTER 2: PEOPLE'S BELONGINGNESS TO GROUPS IN THE SOUTH ASIAN COUNTRIES

SLOs

- Explain what is a group.
- Describe a number of groups that people belong to.
- Describe the functions of those groups.
- Explain ways in which people are part of various communities.
- List benefits of belonging to groups.
- Describe roles that an individual can have within a group and across a range of groups.
- Give examples of how people may acquire roles.
- Explain what people do when they fulfill particular roles.
- Identify the rights and responsibilities individuals have within a group.
- Explain how rights and responsibilities might vary in different groups.

Introduction

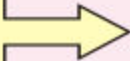
In this chapter, you will learn about different types of groups and what it means to be part of a group. You will carry out a survey of community groups as and their members and identify different types of organizations, their composition, and perceived benefits to their members.

Groups

A group is a collection of two or more people that have special characteristics. They are the people with whom we share many norms and values. Groups may be large or small, formal or informal, they range from a group of students to the residents of a local colony. Some examples are: a family is an example of a group where common characteristics are observed, a class of students and a cricket team is also a group having the same features.

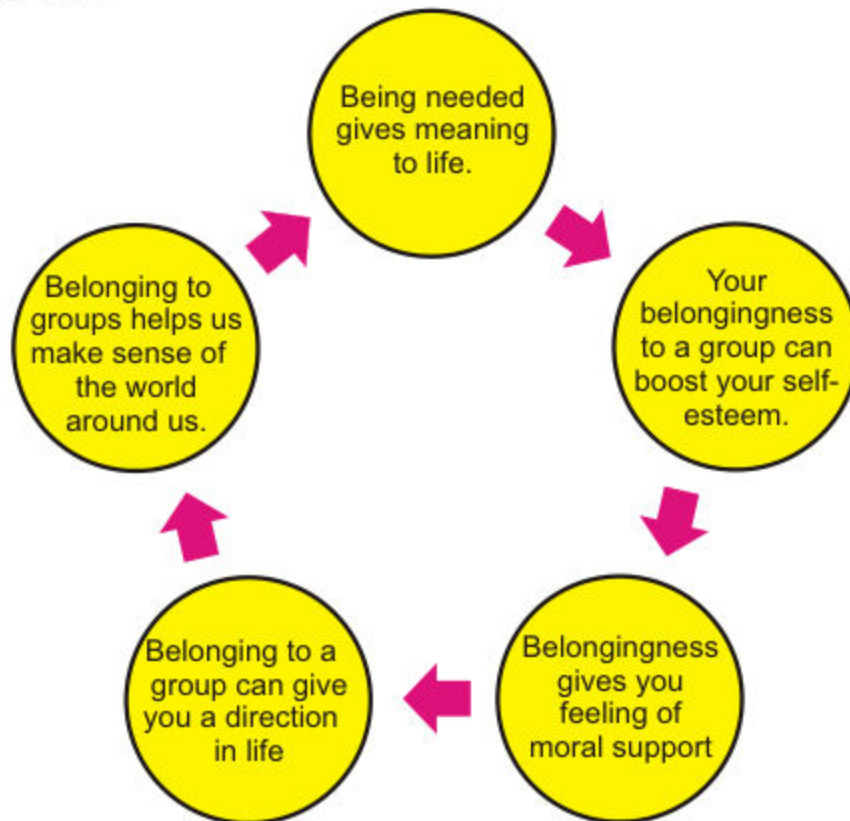
Type of Groups

There are two main types of groups within societies; Primary groups and Secondary groups.

Type of Group	Primary Group	Secondary Group
Definitions	Primary groups are those that are close-knit. They are typically small in number, include close relationships and are usually long lasting. The members of primary groups feel a strong personal identity with the group.	Secondary groups are another type of social group. They can be small or large and are mostly neutral and usually short term. These groups are typically found at work and school.
Examples	Your family which consists of your parents and your sisters and brothers are an example of primary group. Groups of close friends are also a primary group.	Groups such as your class an athletic team and workers in an office are secondary groups.
Activity: Look at your surroundings and make a list of all the possible groups you find and describe the groups that people belong to in your area or locality.		
Activity: Discuss with your friends and write in the given table, how the following have helped you develop a sense of belonging.		
Family		
Friends		
School		

Sense of Belongingness within Social Groups

One of the many things that is common to humans across cultures is the need to belong and be accepted by others. This is one of the reasons people seek to spend time bonding with family, friends, hobby-buddies, sports fans and religious groups. There are many reasons as to why sense of belongingness is important for people. Some of them are discussed below:



Activity:

- After reading the above mentioned importance of being in social groups, discuss with your partner and list other benefits of belongingness to groups and share with the class.

Roles and Responsibilities of Members in Social Groups

In all social groups that we as individuals belong to, we have a status and a role to fulfill. Status is our social position within a group, while a role is the part our society expects us to play in a given status. For example, parents may have the status of father and mother in the family. Because of this status, they are expected to fulfill a certain role for their children that in most societies require them to look after,

educate, guide and protect their children. Another example is of children where they are expected to go to school, be polite and respectful to all, behave well at home and society and develop friendships with their peers.

Activity:

Imagine your family.

- Define the role played by each individual in your family.
- Give examples of how people may have acquired those roles in your family.
- Explain what people do when they fulfill the particular roles.

Within social groups, the members have both individual and group rights. Group rights are also known as collective rights which are held by a group rather than by individual members. Individual rights are rights held by individual people. An example of group rights is the charter of understanding which the labour unions have. They work in relation to the accepted rules of the charter, whereas individual rights are right to live, study, struggle for happiness.

To sum up, you learned the meaning of a group. A social group has been defined as two or more people who interact with one another, share similar characteristics, and have a sense of unity. No two groups are identical to one another, but a group, by definition, is two or more individuals who are connected to one another by social relationships. You also learned about primary groups and secondary groups. Primary groups are smaller than secondary groups.

SUMMARY

It explored the people's belongingness to groups in the south Asian countries, such as type of groups, sense of belongingness within social groups and roles and responsibilities of members in social groups.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- A social group consists of _____ people.
- Examples of a primary group are _____ and _____.
- Examples of secondary group are _____ and _____.

iv. Define the following terms:

- a. Primary Groups
- b. Secondary Groups
- c. Social groups

2. Prepare a Collection of Famous Social Groups of South Asia and Display it in the Class.

B. Use Your Inquiry/ Investigation Skills

1. Search the internet and textbooks and prepare a chart of the type of roles the social group members possess in South Asian societies.
2. Inquire about the different social groups living in South Asian societies and share with your friends.
3. Draw your group of friends and highlight the roles they play and the responsibilities they have.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. In groups compose a list of groups to which you belong. Include primary groups and secondary groups, as well as a description of your social network. Elect a spokesperson from your group to address the class.

END OF UNIT EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. Dashain is the popular festival of _____ country.
- ii. _____ and _____ languages are spoken in Afghanistan.
- iii. The social position that an individual acquires a group is called _____.
- iv. Members have both _____ and _____ rights within groups.

2. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Describe the different aspects of identity of people in South Asia.
- ii. Explain in your own words the roles and responsibilities of members of social groups.
- iii. Write down the reasons why people join social groups?

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Make an inquiry and find out social groups exist in your area.

C. Be Creative

1. Write down the similarities and dissimilarities of primary and secondary groups of provinces in Pakistan.

D. Become Technologically Smart

1. Find out lifestyles along with pictures of South Asian Countries on the internet.

E. Take an Action for the Common Good

1. Prepare a list of common problems of your area and also propose their possible solutions and send to relevant authorities to put an end to those problems.

F. Cooperate With Others

1. Make groups of 4 in your class and discuss and analyze the identical, customs, traditions and festivals of South Asian Countries.

G. Task to do

1. Based on the readings of the South Asian Countries, create a diorama that depicts the purpose, activities, impacts and practices of the South Asian Association of Regional Cooperation (SAARC). After researching the topic, create a three-dimensional diorama using a shoe box/ milk carton. Share the different perspectives of the assigned topic through the diorama. Present your dioramas to the class.
2. Choose a pen-pal from a South Asian country and share with them how SAARC (South Asian Organisation) has helped in developing common goals, lifestyles, festivals, sports, education, health and economic development.
3. Imagine you are a part of the SAARC conference. After consulting your friends, prepare a charter of written rules and regulations for SAARC countries that can help them grow and develop.

